

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing ▶

PAPER 3 Listening

PAPER 4 Speaking

Essential tips

- ▶ Part 1 is always an essay in response to a proposition of some kind, made, for example, in a seminar or lecture or panel discussion. Your task is to develop and support an argument on the particular topic supplied. You cannot predict what the topic will be, but you can learn to identify the advantages and disadvantages of various propositions and how to present them in an organised way.
- ▶ You should practise working on 'for and against' essays and familiarise yourself with the correct structure: an introduction, main body (usually two paragraphs) and a conclusion.
- ▶ Use formal language in the Part 1 essay and present your argument clearly. State the topic, then provide the key points for and against the proposal, supporting these ideas, where possible, with examples or justifications.
- ▶ If you happen to feel strongly about the topic, be sure to remain objective. Don't use emotional language and don't express your own opinion until the final paragraph of the essay.
- ▶ Practise using appropriate linking words and phrases to introduce points, to add points, to contrast points and to conclude the essay.
- ▶ Read carefully through questions 2, 3 and 4 in Part 2 before deciding which item you will write. Make sure you know how to structure the text type you choose and that you know the appropriate vocabulary to use.
- ▶ Remember that all questions in Part 2 could require formal or informal writing. The question will not specify which register you should use; you will need to figure this out from the input text. To determine this, pay close attention to the style and tone of the input text, and who the target reader of the piece will be.
- ▶ Read as many letters, reports, proposals and reviews as possible. You can find a wide range of professional reviews, for example, online. (Ensure these are on reputable and professional websites.) Pay attention to how they are structured and the language that they use.
- ▶ In the test, there will be blank pages in the question booklet where you can jot down some notes if you wish. Don't spend too long planning at the expense of completing your written piece.
- ▶ Resist the temptation to reuse any points provided in the input text. You can certainly refer to them, but do so in your own words rather than reproducing them exactly as they appear in the test. It is important to demonstrate your own range of language.
- ▶ You will not be allowed to use a dictionary during the test.

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing

Part 1

PAPER 3 Listening

Part 2

PAPER 4 Speaking

Essential tips

- ▶ Decide which two points you are going to focus on. Then think about how you can expand on and develop each one.
- ▶ Be sure to stick to the point and keep the essay on track. Avoid repeating yourself.
- ▶ Remember, this is an academic essay and the register should be formal. Don't use slang or other informal language.
- ▶ Think about the words and phrases you could use to present each point.
- ▶ You can argue for or against the proposal, but do so objectively. Try not to let your personal feelings come through as you write the essay. Remember, you may state your own opinion in the conclusion, but it shows skill if you can maintain a distance and present the facts clearly. You can also argue both sides of the proposal and write a balanced, objective argument overall.
- ▶ Use examples to support each advantage or disadvantage that you mention. Remember, for the purposes of this exercise, the examples do not have to be real or true.

You **must** answer this question. Write your answer in **220–260** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

- 1 One of your professors is a committed vegetarian. In a recent lecture, she proposed that all meat dishes be removed from the menu in the cafeteria. You have made the notes below.

Why we should ban meat from our cafeteria

- healthier for everyone
- what about animals' rights?
- better environment if no meat consumption

Other students expressed these opinions during the lecture:

"Eating meat is natural and normal and always has been."

"But where does all this stop? Should we also ban milk, cheese and eggs?"

"What about personal choice and people's right to eat whatever they want?"

Write an essay for your professor discussing **two** of the points she made. You should **explain whether or not you think banning meat from the canteen is the best choice for everyone** and **provide reasons** to support your opinions.

You may, if you wish, make use of the opinions expressed in the lecture, but you should use your own words as far as possible.

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing

Part 1

PAPER 3 Listening

Part 2

PAPER 4 Speaking

Essential tips

- ▶ Not all possible Part 2 task types appear on every paper. For example, you could be asked to produce a letter (formal or informal), or you could be asked to write an email.
- ▶ The review question could be based on a book or a film, but you might also be asked to review a product or service, or an event or performance. You may invent any of these items if you wish.

Question 2

- ▶ What is the style of the input text? What register should you use?
- ▶ Don't make the mistake of thinking that an email does not require the same attention to detail as a letter; organisation and layout are equally important here.
- ▶ What can you learn from the instructions and from Dan's email? Underline the information that will be important to consider in your reply.
- ▶ Remember, you can also come up with other points not featured in the input text.

Question 3

- ▶ As you consider answering this question, ask yourself whether you have an adequate range of vocabulary on the topic of transport.
- ▶ Structure in all text types is very important, but in a report it is vital that the information is presented in an organised way, making it easy for the reader to follow and understand. It is a good idea to use headings in a report.

Write an answer to **one** of the questions 2–4 in this part. Write your answer in **220–260** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet. Put the question number in the box at the top of the page.

- 2 A couple of years ago you did a *Volunteering Abroad* programme in South Africa. Your 17-year-old cousin, Dan, is thinking of doing the same thing and has written to you asking about it.

Read the extract from Dan's email.

The animal conservation work you did sounds interesting – can you tell me a bit more about it, for example, which animals did you work with? I definitely hope to do a lot of travelling while I'm there too. Can you suggest anywhere I can visit? I suppose what I'm wondering more than anything is whether you think I'll enjoy it.

Thanks, Paul!

Dan

Write your **email**.

- 3 You see this post on a community website:

Your local council is compiling a web page about public transport options in your town. They would like local people to send in reports about the public transport services they use. In your report, you should:

- mention which services you use and how often you use them
- describe the quality of the service including factors such as cost and reliability
- recommend or suggest any services and facilities that you think are missing.

Write your **report**.

- 4 You receive this flyer from a local arts group.

Film Event

On the grounds of City Hall every Friday this summer we will screen a film free of charge. We would like you to suggest suitable titles, but we specifically want films that are socially relevant today. The screenings will begin at 9.00 p.m. each Friday. Please send us your review of a film that you think would be suitable, giving reasons for your choice.

Write your **review**.

- ▶ Pay attention to the areas mentioned in the input text and don't leave any of them out.
- ▶ Notice that you are also required to include some suggestions or recommendations in your report.

Question 4

- ▶ Be careful not to rush in and write a review of any film you happen to like very much. In this case, it must be socially relevant.

- ▶ What does *socially relevant* mean? You need to demonstrate in your review that your chosen film has social relevance.
- ▶ Bear in mind that this will be a public screening. Will the event mainly be for adults? How can you tell?

- ▶ The film you write about does not have to be real; you can make one up to suit this purpose. The important thing is that you provide a proper assessment of the film and show how it would be a suitable choice for the event.